10 Hebrew Words Your English Bible Hides

Translator’s notes from the New Messianic Version (Tov Rose)

For each of ten Hebrew words: what English Bibles print,
what the Hebrew carries, one real NMV verse quoted verbatim,
and what the NMV’s translation choice reveals.

By Tov Rose, translator of the New Messianic Version (NMV) · October 2026

$14 one-time

Contents

Why ten words matter

1. Elōhīm — “God”

2. Yehōvah — “LORD”

3. Adōnai — “Lord”

4. Ro’i — “my shepherd”

5. Noach — “Noah”

6. Shem — “Shem”

7. Yerushalayim — “Jerusalem”

8. Yisra’el — “Israel”

9. Tziyon — “Zion”

10. Yah — hidden inside “Hallelujah”

What the NMV is doing — the pattern

From the same translator

About the author

Honesty note: Tov Rose translated the NMV. Every verse is quoted word for word from the NMV corpus; the bracketed notes are the NMV’s own translation choices, exactly as they print. The complete NMV text is free on YouVersion (nmvbible.org).

A note on honesty, up front: I translated the New Messianic Version. Every verse quoted here is the NMV's actual rendering — quoted word for word from the NMV corpus, not from my memory of what it says. The bracketed notes are the NMV's own translation choices, shown exactly as they print on the page. That is the whole point of this guide: you can see what the translators are doing, and you can check it yourself — the complete NMV text is free on YouVersion (nmvbible.org).

Why ten words matter

English Bibles do something invisible: they smooth out the Hebrew. Names of God become titles. Personal names become bare labels. Whole prophecies get buried inside transliterations nobody is meant to understand.

This guide walks through ten Hebrew words the way the NMV renders them. For each word you get: what English Bibles usually print, what the Hebrew carries, one real NMV verse (verbatim), and what the NMV's translation choice tells you that the English hid.

If you read the *Messianic Bible Buyer's Guide*, this is its Part 2 — the deeper companion: not which Bible to buy, but what the Hebrew actually says.

The brackets, decoded — how the NMV prints its choices

If you open an NMV page you will notice marks no other Bible uses. Here is the key, so nothing in this guide feels like a code:

- **Square brackets** — the translator's own notes: identifications of who is speaking ([The First Born Son], [Messiah Pre-Incarnate]) and meaning glosses ([Foundation Of Peace], [Parched Place]). Nothing in brackets is in the Hebrew text itself; it is the translation showing its work.
- **Parentheses ( )** — Hebrew names and their meanings, unpacked where they appear (Noach (Rest, Consolation); the Lord-Adōnai (The Father)).
- **Asterisks and italics** — words supplied by the translator for English readability, the same honesty system the King James translators started with their italics.

This is the NMV's governing rule, from the publisher's own site

(nmvbible.org): the "names" aren't names — they're how you know WHO is speaking. Every one of the ten words in this guide is chosen to show that rule working.

Three comparisons to try tonight

You don't need to take this guide's word for anything. The NMV's complete text is free on YouVersion (nmvbible.org). Open these three passages there, then open them in the English Bible you grew up with:

- **Psalm 23:1.** Your Bible: "The LORD is my shepherd." The NMV: "Yehōvah Ro'i [Messiah Pre-Incarnate My shepherd]." Ask: which "LORD" is your shepherd — and does it change the psalm to know?
- **Genesis 1:1.** Your Bible: "In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth." The NMV: "[All of that] Beginning [stuff] God-Elōhīm [The First Born Son] created the 'Universe and Everything in it.'" Ask: who was doing the creating?
- **Psalm 2:6.** Your Bible: "Yet have I set my king upon my holy hill of Zion." The NMV: "Yet have I set my king upon my holy hill of Tziyon [Parched Place]." Ask: what does "parched" do to a word that usually sounds like a victory song?

That is the whole method of this guide: real renderings, side by side, with the translation's own notes showing. Now the ten words.

---

1. Elōhīm — "God"

What English Bibles usually print: "God."

What's hidden: "God" is a category. Elōhīm is a title — the Many Powered — and the NMV treats it as exactly that: a functional description assigned to a

specific member of the Godhead, passage by passage.

> NMV, Genesis 1:1 (verbatim): "[All of that] Beginning [stuff] God-Elōhīm [The First Born Son] created the 'Universe and Everything in it.'"

The NMV's choice: "God-Elōhīm," with a bracketed identification — here, [The First Born Son]. The NMV's core commitment (nmvbible.org: "the 'names' aren't names — they're how you know WHO is speaking") is to mark who is acting. In Genesis 1 the Creator acting is the Son, and the translation refuses to let you miss it.

---

2. Yehōvah — "LORD"

What English Bibles usually print: "LORD" (small caps).

What's hidden: Four hundred years of tradition replaced the name God gave Himself with a title. Open most English Bibles and you can read cover to cover without once meeting the Name.

> NMV, Psalm 1:2 (verbatim): "But his delight *is* in the law of the LORD-Yehōvah [Messiah Pre-Incarnate]; and in his law does he meditate day and night."

The NMV's choice: "LORD-Yehōvah," keeping the familiar word while restoring the name beside it — plus the bracketed identification [Messiah Pre-Incarnate], the NMV's reading that the Yehōvah speaking in the Tanakh is the Son before His incarnation.

---

3. Adōnai — "Lord"

What English Bibles usually print: "Lord."

What's hidden: "Lord" is doing double and triple duty. In English you cannot tell which Hebrew word is underneath — and in the NMV's reading, you cannot tell *who* is speaking.

> NMV, Psalm 2:4 (verbatim): "He that sits in the heavens shall laugh: the Lord-Adōnai (The Father)[Greatest Above All Things] shall have them in ridicule (laughing at enemies' threats)."

The NMV's choice: "Lord-Adōnai," with the identification (The Father).

Same psalm, two speakers: Yehōvah (the Son, verses 1–2) and Adōnai (the Father, verse 4). The English flattens them into one "Lord." The NMV marks the handoff.

---

4. Ro'i — "my shepherd"

What English Bibles usually print: "The LORD is my shepherd."

What's hidden: Two Hebrew words — a name and a title — each carrying weight. Psalm 23:1 is not "a shepherd." It is *Yehōvah* as *Ro'i*.

> NMV, Psalm 23:1 (verbatim): "Yehōvah Ro'i [Messiah Pre-Incarnate My shepherd]; I shall not lack."

The NMV's choice: transliterate, don't smooth: "Yehōvah Ro'i," with the bracket holding both the identification [Messiah Pre-Incarnate] and the plain English "My shepherd." You get the Hebrew pairing and the meaning in one line.

---

5. Noach — "Noah"

What English Bibles usually print: "Noah."

What's hidden: In English, "Noah" is just a name. In the Hebrew narrative the name is the prophecy — and the text explains itself, if the translation lets it.

> NMV, Genesis 5:29 (verbatim): "And he called his name Noach (Rest, Consolation; this root 'signifies not only absence of movement but being settled in a particular place with overtones of finality, or victory, salvation etc.'), saying, This *same* shall comfort us concerning our work and toil of our hands, because of the ground which the LORD-Yehōvah (Messiah Pre-Incarnate)has cursed."

The NMV's choice: transliterate "Noach" and unpack the root in the parentheses — "Rest, Consolation" — then let the verse's own "This same shall comfort us" land as the fulfillment of the naming. The prophecy was in the name all along.

---

6. Shem — "Shem"

What English Bibles usually print: "Shem."

What's hidden: "He shall dwell in the tents of Shem" reads, in English, like a geography footnote. Shem means "name, great reputation." The verse is talking about *whose name* the world will dwell in.

> NMV, Genesis 9:27 (verbatim): "God-Elōhīm [The Living Word - The Many Powered] shall enlarge Yefet (enlarged; fair; persuading), and he shall dwell in the tents of Shem (name, great reputation; well-known)); and Kena'an (merchant; trader; or that humbles and subdues) shall be his servant."

The NMV's choice: gloss every name in the line — Yefet, Shem, Kena'an — so the blessing reads as prophecy, not genealogy. The nations will dwell in the tents of the Name.

---

7. Yerushalayim — "Jerusalem"

What English Bibles usually print: "Jerusalem."

What's hidden: The English form has been worn smooth by two thousand years of use. The Hebrew is a compound: the city whose name means peace — and the NMV makes you hear it.

> NMV, Psalm 147:2 (verbatim): "The LORD-Yehōvah [Messiah Pre-Incarnate] does build up Yerushalayim [Foundation Of Peace]: he gathers together the outcasts of Yisra'el [He Holds Onto The Heel of God]."

The NMV's choice: transliterate "Yerushalayim" and bracket the meaning —

[Foundation Of Peace]. The verse is no longer about rebuilding a city; it is about God building up the foundation of peace itself.

---

8. Yisra'el — "Israel"

What English Bibles usually print: "Israel."

What's hidden: "Israel" is a label on a map in English. The Hebrew is a memory: the man who wrestled through the night and held on to the heel — and the name his descendants carry.

> NMV, Psalm 147:2 (verbatim): "The LORD-Yehōvah [Messiah Pre-Incarnate] does build up Yerushalayim [Foundation Of Peace]: he gathers together the outcasts of Yisra'el [He Holds Onto The Heel of God]."

The NMV's choice: "Yisra'el [He Holds Onto The Heel of God]." One line earlier (Psalm 147:12) the NMV does the same for Tziyon — the city becomes a meaning again. Names are not labels in this translation; they are the story, retold every time they appear.

---

9. Tziyon — "Zion"

What English Bibles usually print: "Zion."

What's hidden: "Zion" has become a slogan word — songs, movements, merchandise. Underneath it is a parched hill in Jerusalem, and a Hebrew word with a rough edge.

> NMV, Psalm 2:6 (verbatim): "Yet have I set my king upon my holy hill of Tziyon [Parched Place]."

The NMV's choice: "Tziyon [Parched Place]." The gloss refuses to let the word go poetic. The King is set on a dry, real hill — and the "parched" edge sharpens the psalm's contrast: earth's kings raging against God's anointed, on

a hill the psalm itself calls barren.

---

10. Yah — hidden inside "Hallelujah"

What English Bibles usually print: "Praise the LORD" / "Hallelujah."

What's hidden: Hallelujah is a Hebrew sentence smuggled into English as a single word: *hallelu* ("praise") + *Yah*, the shortened form of the Name.

Most readers never hear the name they are singing.

> NMV, Psalm 148:1 (verbatim, Hebrew script omitted for font coverage — corpus reads "[יָהּ- Behold The Hand]"): "Praise you the LORD- Yah [Behold The Hand] (Messiah Pre-Incarnate). Praise you the LORD-Yehōvah [Messiah Pre-Incarnate] from the heavens: praise him in the heights."

The NMV's choice: "the LORD- Yah," with the Hebrew letters in the bracket and the gloss [Behold The Hand] — the NMV's reading of the letters' meaning — plus the standing identification (Messiah Pre-Incarnate). The "Hallelujah" you have sung your whole life had a name in it. Now you can see whose.

What the NMV is doing — the pattern

Across all ten words, one commitment repeats:

- **Restore the Hebrew form** where the English smooths it (Elōhīm, Yehōvah, Noach, Tziyon).
- **Gloss the meaning in brackets or parentheses** so you never lose the sense (Rest, Consolation; Foundation Of Peace; Parched Place).
- **Mark who is speaking** — the bracketed identifications ([The First Born Son], [Messiah Pre-Incarnate], (The Father)) are the NMV's signature move.

The published NMV is the publisher's own word — a proof of concept, not a full translation. The second edition now in development is the full translation built on the research behind *Jesus: The God of Abraham, Isaac & Jacob*

(2024). The complete current text is free on YouVersion (nmvbible.org) — read Psalm 23 there and compare it with what you just read here.

From the same translator

- **The Messianic Bible Buyer's Guide** ($14) — NMV, TLV, and CJB compared side by side: real verse samples, verified editions and prices, and a decision guide. The companion this guide continues. https://c2r-marketing.github.io/messianic-bible-guide/
- **Bible-study-software hub** — comparing the tools for studying these texts (Logos and the rest), with honest affiliate disclosures. https://c2r-marketing.github.io/bible-study-software-hub/

About the author

Tov Rose translated the New Messianic Version Bible and has authored more than 30 books, including *Jesus: The God of Abraham, Isaac & Jacob* (2024), the research foundation for the NMV's second edition. This guide is published by C2R Marketing, LLC. © 2026. All rights reserved.

Affiliate disclosure: purchase links in the online companion to this guide are marked "Update Pending" until the publisher affiliate approvals clear. When live, they pay the publisher of this guide a commission at no extra cost to you. The NMV links support the NMV second-edition translation work.